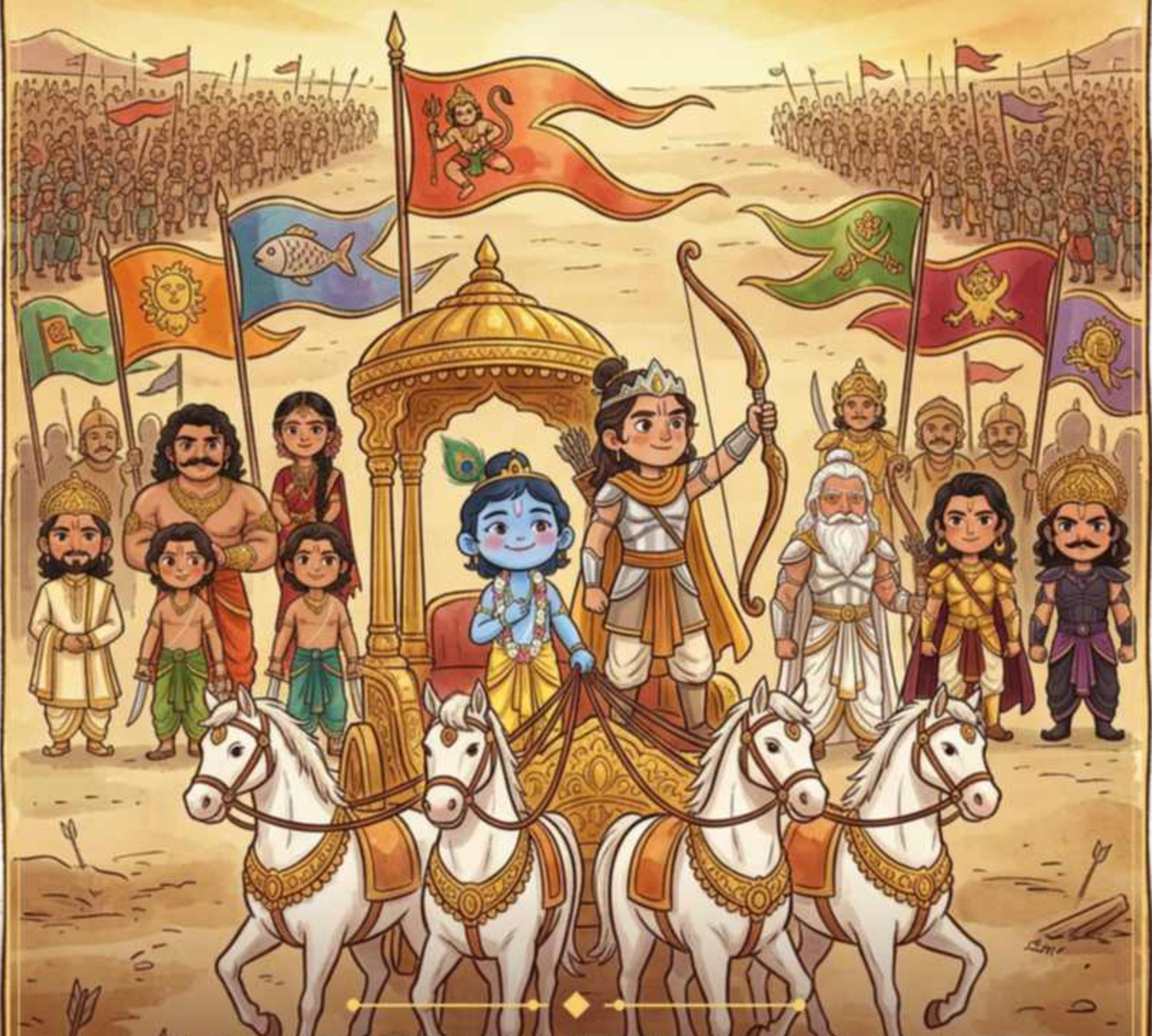
THE GREAT EPIC

MAHABHARATA

The Great Story of Dharma



A COMIC BOOK FOR STUDENTS & FAMILIES

KASARANENI ISHA

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THE BEGINNING OF THE KURU DYNASTY



Long ago, there was a powerful kingdom called Hastinapura. It was ruled by the Kuru dynasty.



King Shantanu: "The happiness of my kingdom is my greatest responsibility."

King Shantanu married Goddess Ganga, and they had a son named Devavrata.



Later, Shantanu wished to marry Satyavati. To make his father's wish come true, Devavrata made a terrible promise.

Devavrata: "I promise that I will never become king, and I will never marry."



His sacrifice was so great that he received the name Bhishma.

Bhishma: "I will protect this kingdom until my last breath."

THE BIRTH OF THE KURU PRINCES



After many years, the royal family welcomed three princes: Dhritarashtra, Pandu and Vidura.



Dhritarashtra was blind from birth, Pandu became king, and Vidura was known for his wisdom.



Pandu had five sons, known as the Pandavas: Yudhishthira, Bhima, Arjuna, Nakula and Sahadeva.



Dhritarashtra and Gandhari had one hundred sons, known as the Kauravas. Duryodhana was the eldest.

Duryodhana: "One day, I will become the ruler of Hastinapura!"

CHILDHOOD RIVALRY

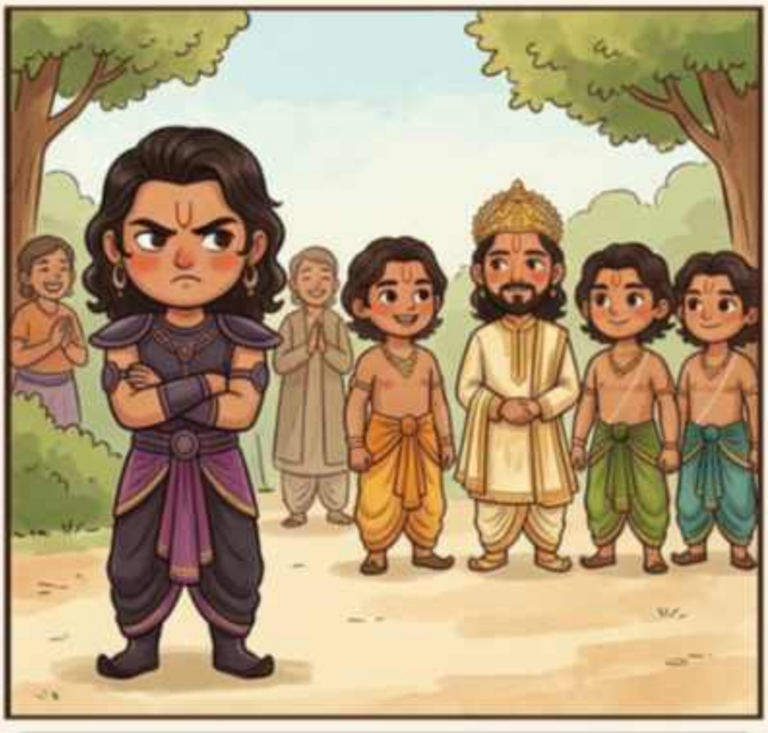


The Pandavas and Kauravas grew up together in the royal palace.



Bhima: "Come on, brothers! Let's play!"

Bhima was extremely strong, while Arjuna was talented with the bow and arrow.



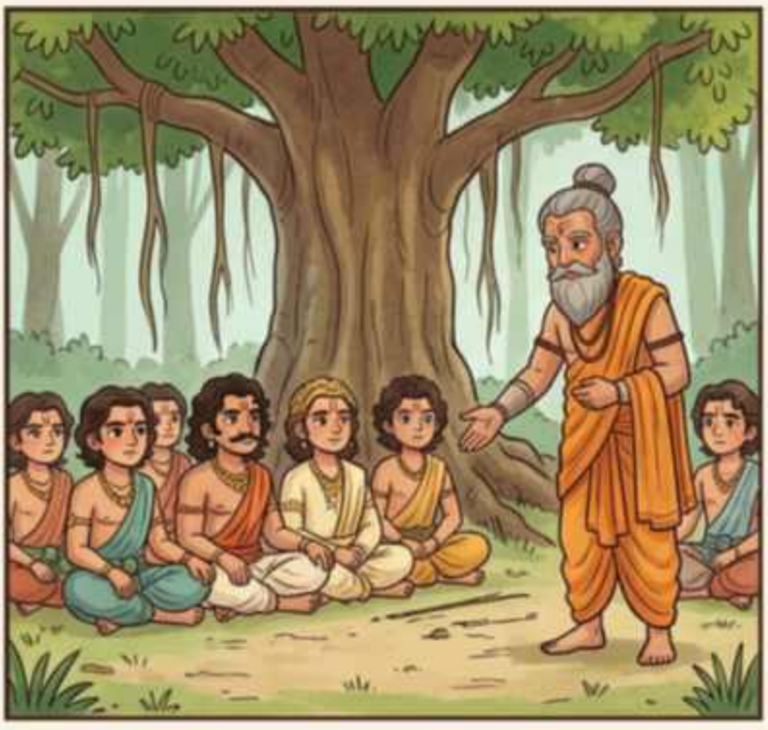
Duryodhana: "Why does everyone praise the Pandavas? I should be the greatest!"



Shakuni: "Dear Duryodhana, if you want the throne, you must find a way to defeat them."

Jealousy slowly grew between the cousins.

THE GURU AND THE TEST OF ARJUNA



The princes were sent to learn warfare and royal duties under Guru Dronacharya.

Dronacharya: "A true warrior needs discipline, patience and concentration."



Arjuna became one of his most dedicated students.



Dronacharya: "Arjuna, what do you see?"

Arjuna: "Only the eye of the bird, Guruji."



Arjuna hit the target perfectly. Dronacharya was proud of his focus and skill.

Dronacharya: "Your concentration will make you a great archer."

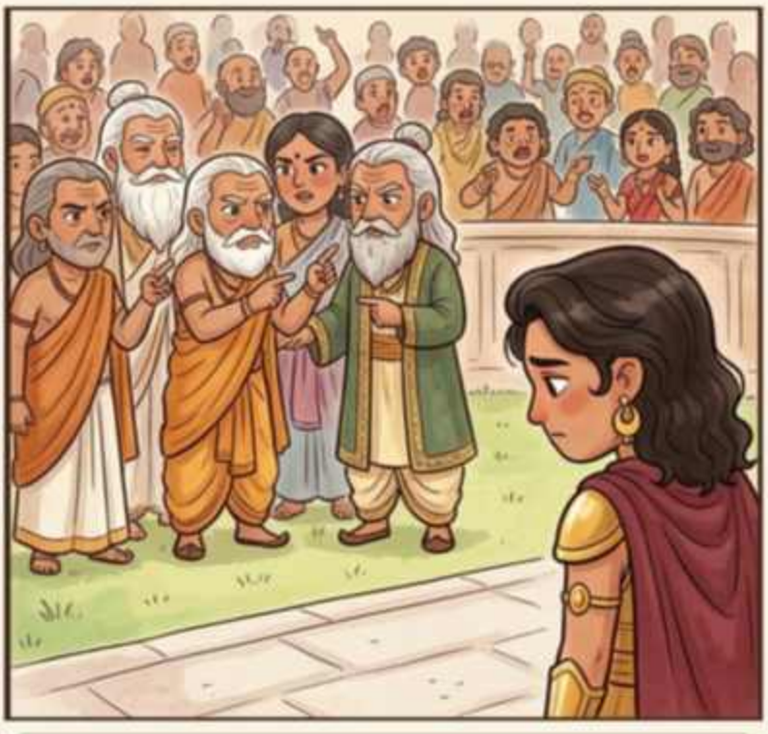
KARNA ENTERS THE STORY



During a royal display of the princes' skills, Arjuna amazed everyone with his archery.



Karna: "I can perform the same skills as Arjuna!"



Some people questioned Karna's background and refused to accept him as Arjuna's equal.



Duryodhana: "I will make you the king of Anga!"

Karna: "I will never forget your friendship."

From that day, Karna became Duryodhana's loyal friend.

THE LAC HOUSE PLAN



Duryodhana and Shakuni became worried about the growing popularity of the Pandavas.



Shakuni: "Let us send them to a palace made of highly flammable materials."



The Pandavas were invited to stay in a beautiful house at Varanavata, unaware of the dangerous plan.



With Vidura's secret warning, the Pandavas escaped through an underground tunnel when the house caught fire.

Bhima: "We must protect our family and stay together!"

DRAUPADI'S SWAYAMVARA



During their journey, the Pandavas reached the kingdom of Panchala, where Princess Draupadi's swayamvara was taking place.



The challenge was to hit a target by looking at its reflection in water.



Arjuna: "I will try."

Disguised as a Brahmin, Arjuna successfully completed the challenge.



Draupadi: "I accept you as my husband."

Draupadi became the wife of all five Pandavas, following the circumstances and decision described in the epic.

THE KINGDOM OF INDRAPRASTHA



The Pandavas returned to Hastinapura. To avoid further conflict, they were given a portion of the kingdom.



Yudhishthira: "We will turn this land into a beautiful kingdom."



With hard work and guidance, the Pandavas built the magnificent city of Indraprastha.



Yudhishthira performed the Rajasuya Yagna and became a respected emperor. Duryodhana's jealousy grew stronger.

Duryodhana: "How can they become so powerful?"

THE GAME OF DICE

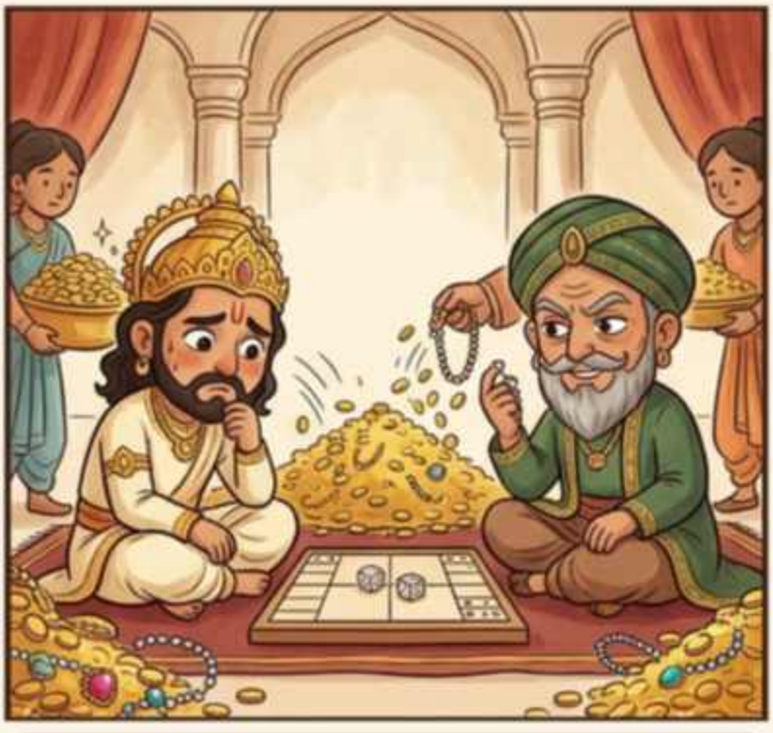


Shakuni invited Yudhishthira to a game of dice in Hastinapura.



Shakuni: "Come, Yudhishthira. Let us play a friendly game."

Shakuni used his clever tricks to win.



Yudhishthira lost his wealth, kingdom, brothers and even himself. He then staked Draupadi.



Draupadi: "How can a person who has already lost himself stake another person? Is this justice?"

The royal court fell silent.

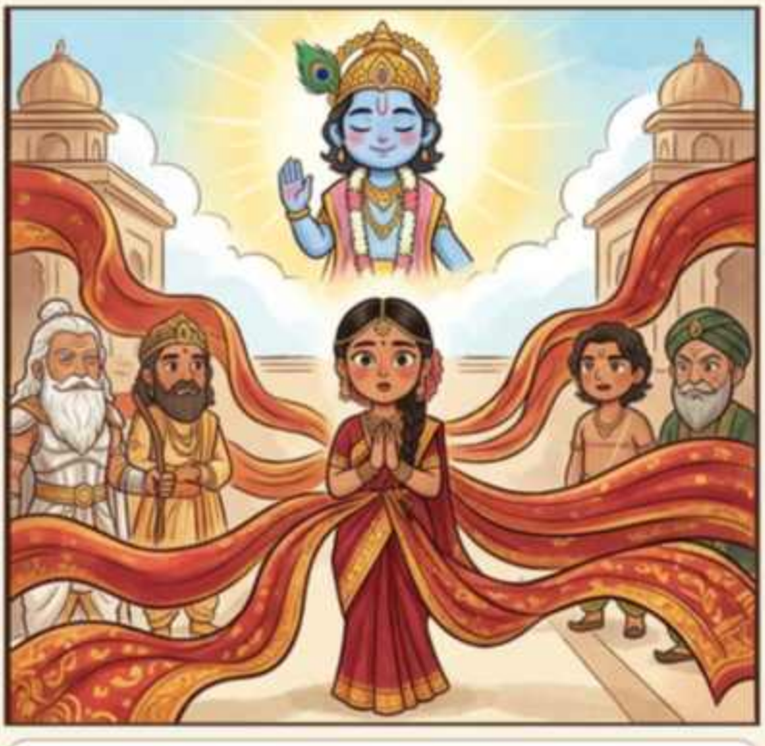
DRAUPADI'S HUMILIATION AND KRISHNA'S HELP



Duryodhana ordered Dushasana to bring Draupadi into the court.



Dushasana attempted to disrobe her. Draupadi prayed to Lord Krishna for help.
Draupadi: "Krishna! You are my only hope!"



According to the traditional account, Krishna protected Draupadi, and the cloth kept appearing endlessly.



Bhima became furious and made a vow to punish those responsible for Draupadi's humiliation.
Bhima: "This injustice will not go unanswered!"

THE THIRTEEN YEARS OF EXILE



The Pandavas were sent into twelve years of forest exile, followed by one year of living in disguise.



Arjuna: "I will seek divine weapons to prepare for the future."

Arjuna performed penance and received powerful celestial weapons.



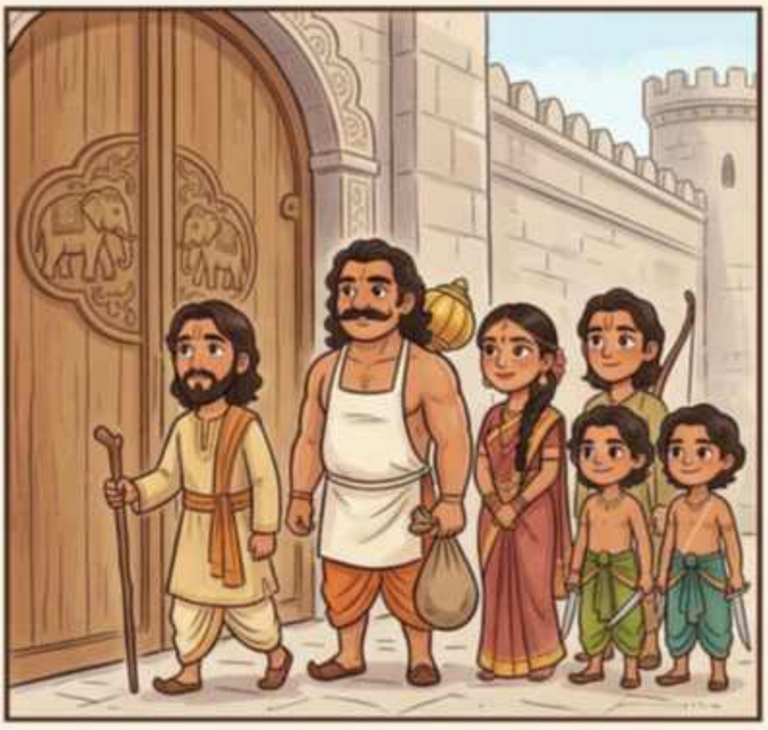
During their forest life, the Pandavas faced many challenges and met sages who shared valuable wisdom.



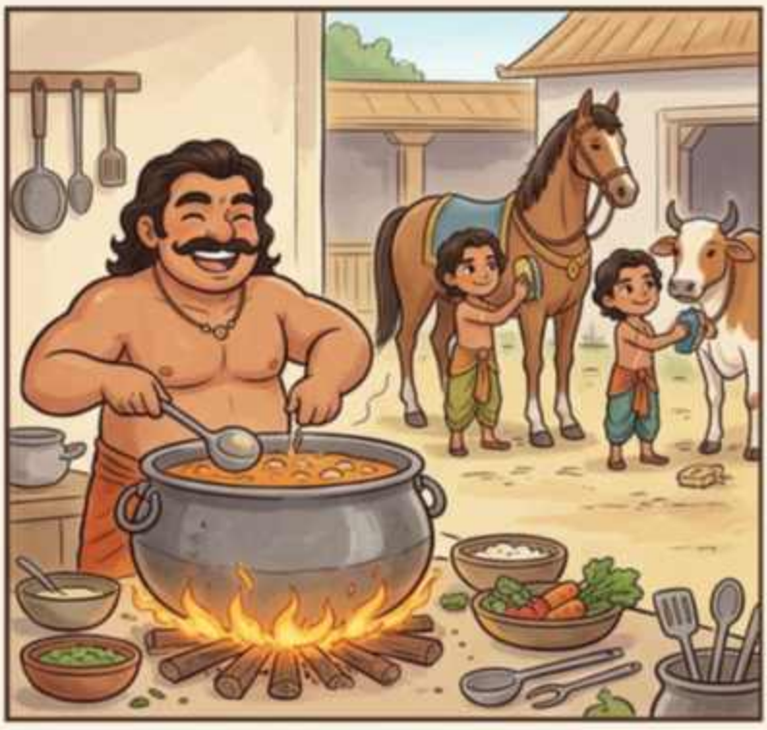
Yudhishthira: "We must remain patient. Our time will come."

The Pandavas completed their thirteen years of exile.

THE YEAR IN DISGUISE



The Pandavas entered the kingdom of Virata and lived in disguise.



Yudhishthira worked as a royal adviser, Bhima as a cook, Arjuna as a dance teacher, and Nakula and Sahadeva cared for horses and cattle. Draupadi served the queen.



When the Kauravas attacked Virata's cattle, Arjuna revealed his identity and defeated the attackers.



The Pandavas successfully completed their final year of exile.

Arjuna: "We have kept our promise. Now it is time to ask for justice."

KRISHNA'S PEACE MISSION



The Pandavas asked Duryodhana to return their kingdom.



Krishna: "Avoid war. Give the Pandavas even five villages and let peace prevail."



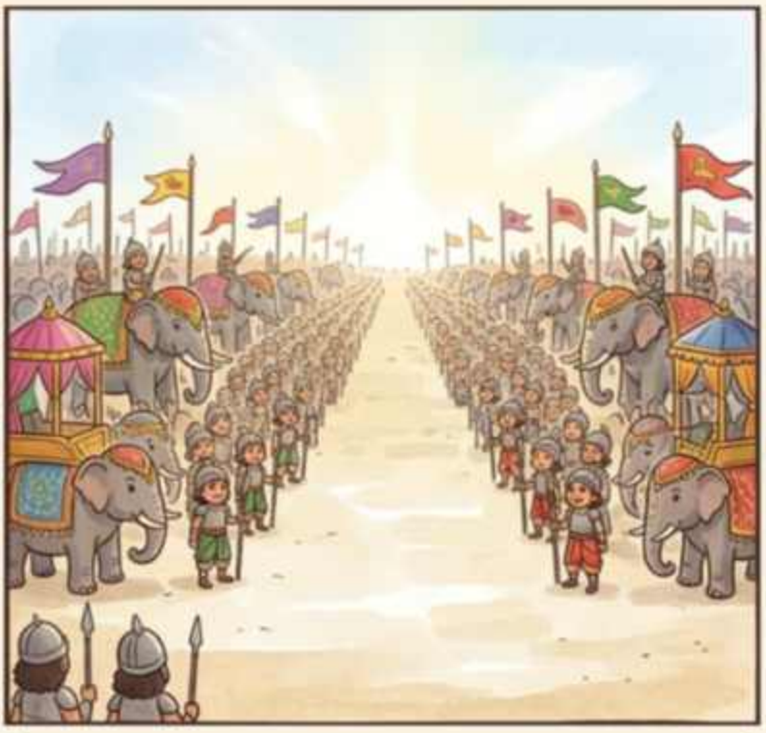
Duryodhana: "I will not give them even a piece of land!"



Krishna's peace mission failed. Both sides began preparing for the great war.

Krishna: "When greed destroys wisdom, conflict becomes unavoidable."

THE GREAT BATTLE BEGINS



Kings and warriors from many kingdoms gathered at Kurukshetra.



Duryodhana chose Lord Krishna's army, while Arjuna chose Krishna himself as his charioteer.



Arjuna: "Krishna, take my chariot between the two armies."



Seeing his teachers, relatives and friends on both sides, Arjuna became deeply troubled.

Arjuna: "How can I fight against my own family?"

THE BHAGAVAD GITA



Arjuna: "I cannot fight this war. I would rather put down my weapons."



Krishna: "You must understand the difference between the temporary body and the eternal soul."



Krishna: "Do your duty with sincerity. Focus on your actions, not only on the results."



Krishna explained the paths of knowledge, action, meditation and devotion. These teachings became known as the Bhagavad Gita.

Arjuna: "My confusion is gone, Krishna. I will do my duty."

THE FALL OF BHISHMA



The Kurukshetra War began. Bhishma led the Kaurava army and fought with great strength.



The Pandavas struggled against Bhishma because they deeply respected him.



With Shikhandi in front, Arjuna released arrows at Bhishma, who chose not to fight Shikhandi.



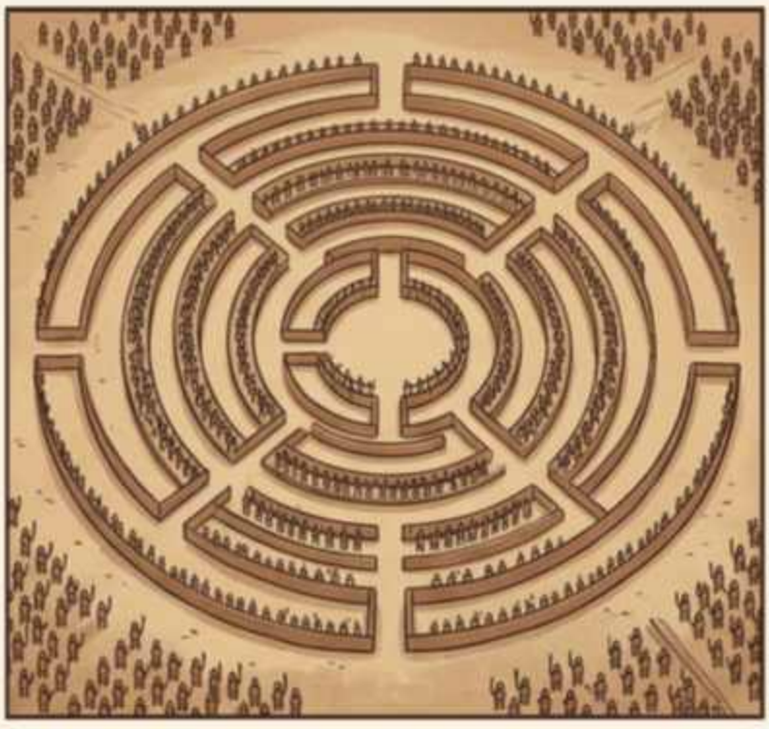
Bhishma fell onto a bed of arrows but did not die immediately.

Bhishma: "I will wait for the right time to leave this world."

THE FALL OF ABHIMANYU



Dronacharya became the commander of the Kaurava army.



The Kauravas formed a powerful battle formation called the Chakravyuha.



Abhimanyu: "I know how to enter this formation. I will face it bravely."

Young Abhimanyu entered the formation but could not find a way out.



Surrounded by many warriors, Abhimanyu was killed through an unfair attack.

Arjuna: "I vow to defeat Jayadratha before sunset tomorrow!"

ARJUNA'S VOW AND GHATOTKACHA'S SACRIFICE



Arjuna fought fiercely to fulfil his vow and reach Jayadratha.



With Krishna's guidance, Arjuna defeated Jayadratha before sunset.

Arjuna: "My son's death will not be forgotten!"



During the night battle, Bhima's son Ghatotkacha used his magical powers to trouble the Kaurava army.



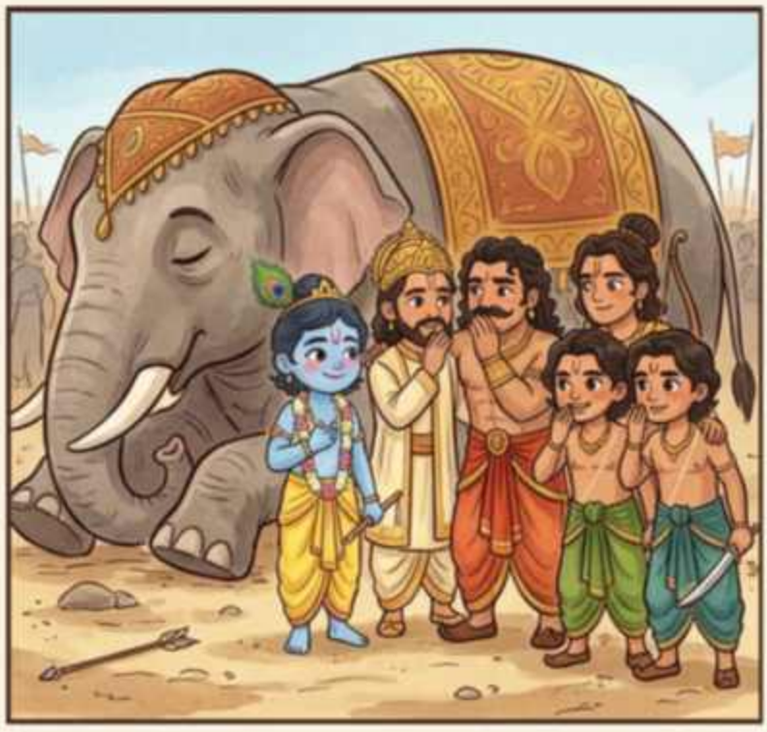
Karna used his powerful divine weapon, which he had saved for Arjuna, to kill Ghatotkacha.

Krishna: "This sacrifice has saved Arjuna from that deadly weapon."

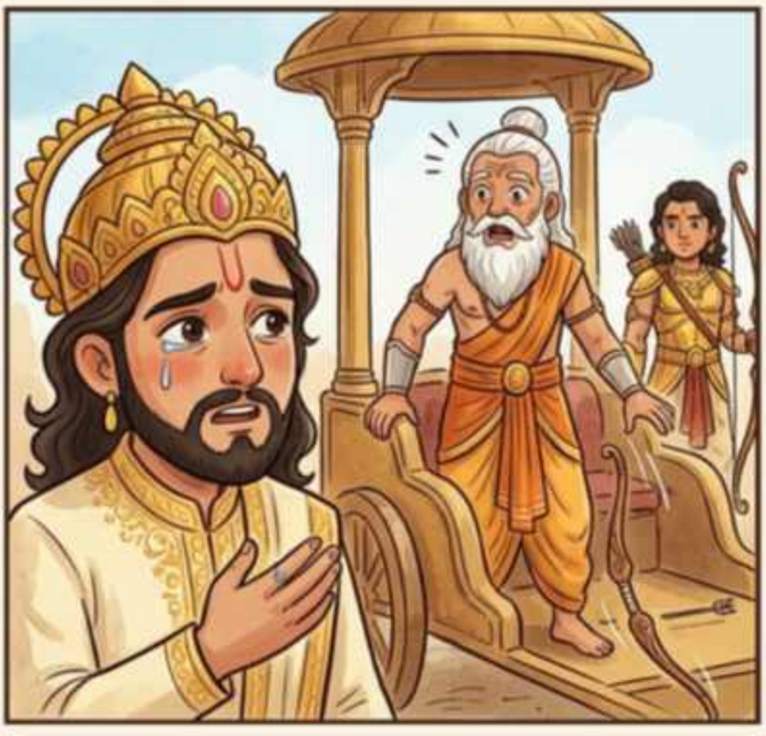
THE FALL OF DRONACHARYA



Dronacharya was nearly impossible to defeat while holding his weapons.



The Pandavas used a strategy involving the news that Ashwatthama had died. An elephant with the same name had actually been killed.



Yudhishthira: "Ashwatthama is dead..."

Dronacharya heard only the words he feared and laid down his weapons.



Dhrishtadyumna killed Dronacharya, ending the life of the great teacher.

THE FALL OF KARNA



Karna became the commander of the Kaurava army. He was a powerful warrior and the eldest son of Kunti, a truth hidden for many years.



Kunti: "Karna, you are my firstborn son. The Pandavas are your brothers."

Karna: "I cannot abandon Duryodhana, who stood by me when the world rejected me."



During his battle with Arjuna, Karna's chariot wheel became stuck in the ground.



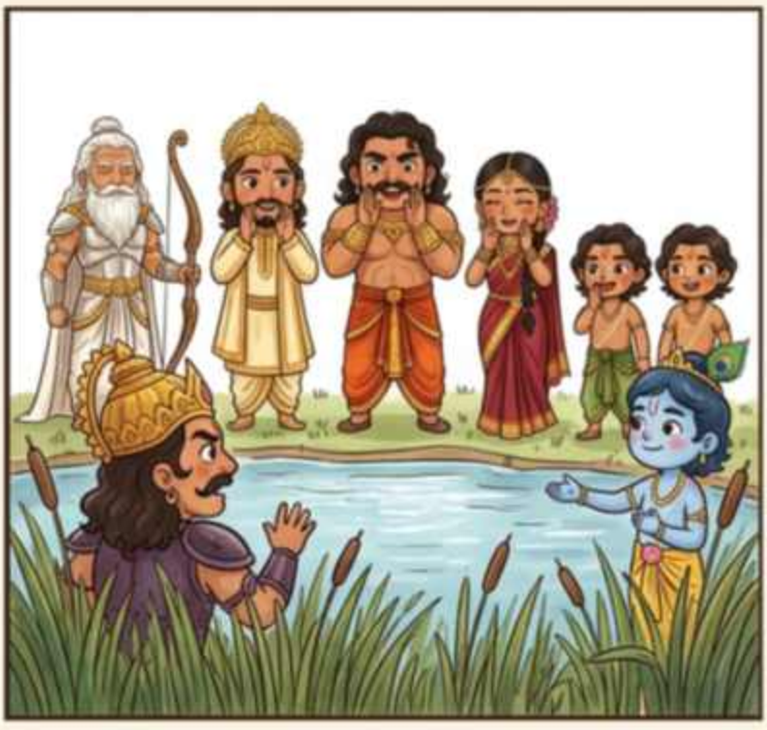
Following Krishna's guidance, Arjuna released his arrow and Karna was killed.

Krishna: "War brings painful consequences, even for the greatest warriors."

THE END OF DURYODHANA



Shalya became the final commander of the Kaurava army. After his defeat, only a few Kaurava warriors remained.



Duryodhana hid in a lake, but the Pandavas found him and challenged him to fight.



Bhima and Duryodhana fought a fierce mace battle.



Following Krishna's signal, Bhima struck Duryodhana on the thigh, fulfilling his vow. Duryodhana fell, and the war was nearly over.

Bhima: "The injustice against Draupadi has been answered."

THE NIGHT OF ASHWATTHAMA



After the war, Ashwatthama, Kripacharya and Kritavarma remained among the surviving Kaurava warriors.



Filled with anger over his father's death, Ashwatthama attacked the Pandava camp at night.



He killed the sleeping sons of Draupadi and other warriors, believing he was taking revenge.



Draupadi was heartbroken. Ashwatthama was eventually confronted and his divine jewel was taken away.

Draupadi: "Revenge cannot bring back the lives we have lost."

THE AFTERMATH OF WAR



The eighteen-day war ended. The Pandavas had won, but the victory came with enormous loss.



Yudhishthira: "What is the meaning of this victory when so many loved ones are gone?"



Yudhishthira visited Bhishma, who shared his final teachings about duty, leadership, justice and righteousness.

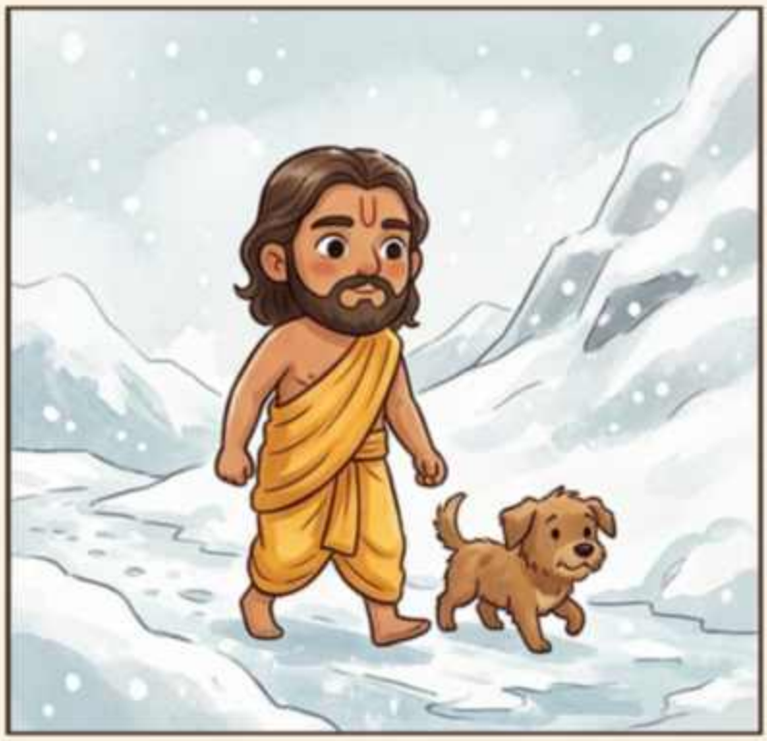


After Bhishma left his body, Yudhishthira became the king of Hastinapura and ruled with wisdom and justice.

THE FINAL JOURNEY OF THE PANDAVAS



After many years, the Pandavas gave up their kingdom and began their final journey towards the Himalayas.



One by one, Draupadi and the four younger Pandavas fell during the journey. Yudhishthira continued walking with a dog beside him.



At the gates of heaven, Yudhishthira was asked to leave the dog behind.

Yudhishthira: "I will not abandon a companion who has stayed loyal to me."



The dog revealed himself as Dharma, the divine father of Yudhishthira. His loyalty and truthfulness were tested. Yudhishthira finally reached heaven.

FINAL MESSAGE

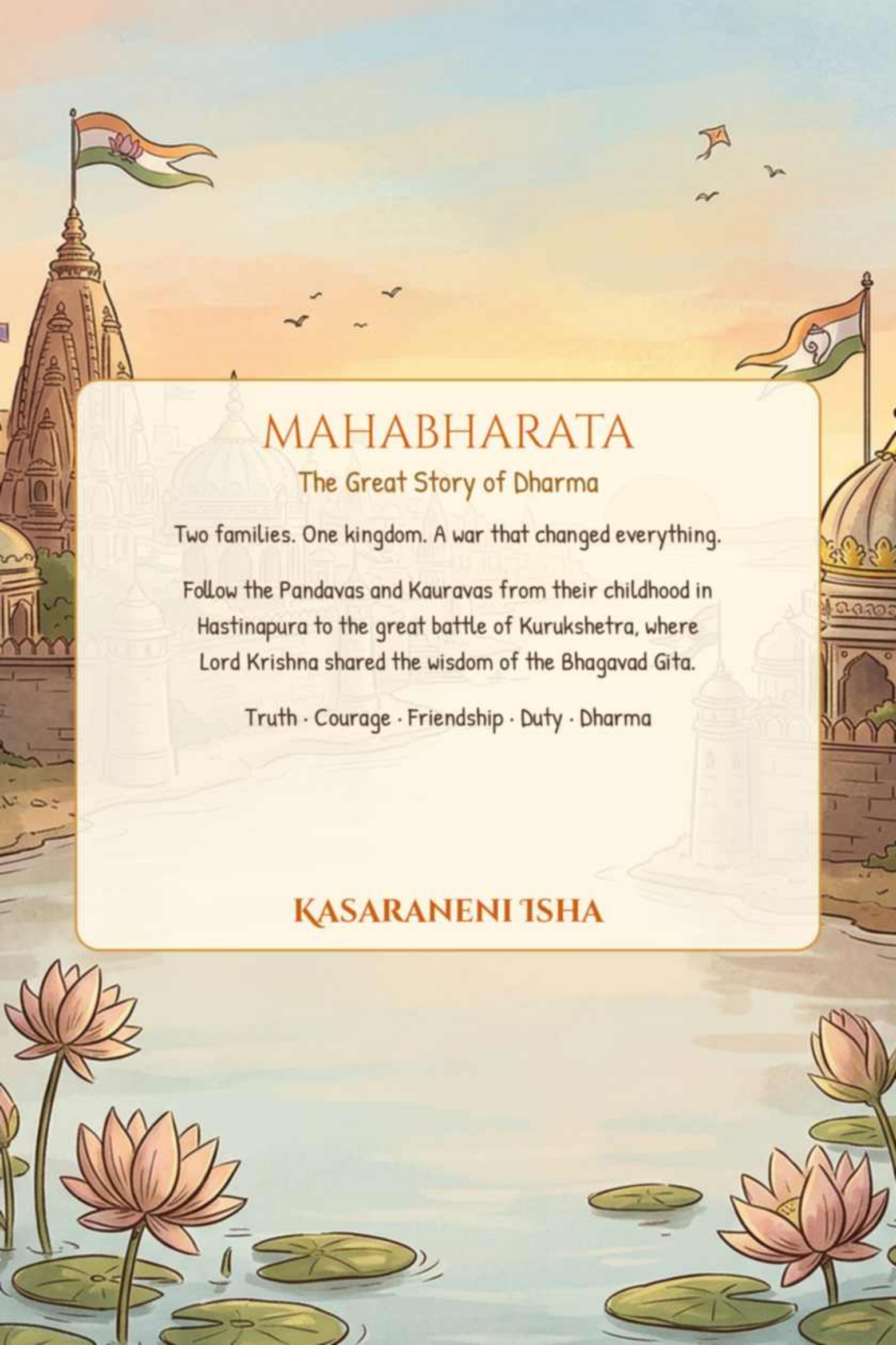
"The Mahabharata is not just a story of a great war. It is a story of family, friendship, promises, jealousy, courage, sacrifice, choices and Dharma."

"It teaches us that the path of righteousness may be difficult, but truth and duty always matter."

THE END

IMPORTANT MESSAGE OF THE MAHABHARATA

- Always choose truth over lies.
- Control jealousy, anger and greed.
- Keep your promises and respect others.
- Stand against injustice.
- Friendship and loyalty are valuable, but never support wrongdoing.
- Do your duty with courage.
- Every action has consequences.



MAHABHARATA

The Great Story of Dharma

Two families. One kingdom. A war that changed everything.

Follow the Pandavas and Kauravas from their childhood in Hastinapura to the great battle of Kurukshetra, where Lord Krishna shared the wisdom of the Bhagavad Gita.

Truth · Courage · Friendship · Duty · Dharma

KASARANENI ISHA